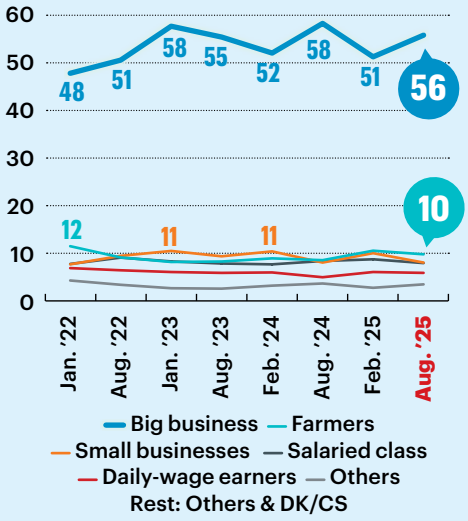
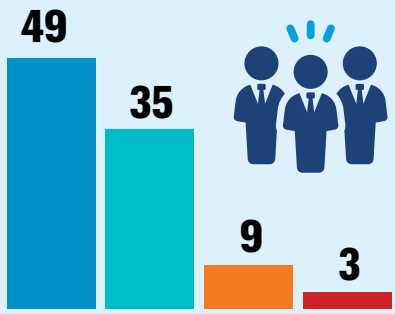
Q. Who has benefited the most from the economic policies of the NDA government?



More than half believe big business has been the main beneficiary of the NDA's policies, a steady trend

Q. Given a choice, what kind of job would you prefer personally?



Government jobs remain the choice for nearly half

Cost of Compliance

It is no secret that entrepreneurs in India have to navigate a maze of compliances across central, state and local jurisdictions before they can even set up shop. A white paper by the consultancy TeamLease Regtech reported last year that Indian businesses are governed by 1,536 acts, involving a staggering 69,233 compliances and 6,618 annual filings. These regulations—part of both central and state laws—vary across businesses and geographies. They are also constantly changing, often blindsiding businesses. The predictable upshot? Delayed decision-making, cost overruns and a setback to the entrepreneurial spirit.

Little surprise, then, that 48.3 per cent of respondents see bureaucracy as an impediment to economic development. A majority—53.5 per cent—say it is difficult to start and run a business, while only 18 per cent find it 'very easy'. Yet there is a glimmer of improvement: 54.1 per cent acknowledge that the Goods and Services Tax (GST) has eased compliance burdens. The Centre's proposal to reduce GST slabs from four to just two is expected to streamline things further.

The Jobs Challenge

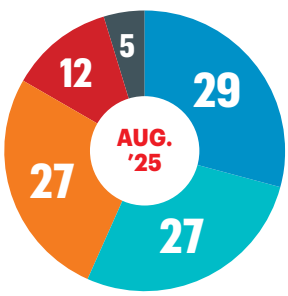
Business uncertainties, the surge of AI-driven technologies and America's move to impose 50 per cent tariffs, including the 25 per cent penalty for sourcing Russian oil, are darkening the mood in the jobs market. White-collar workers are already feeling the squeeze: recent layoffs at Tata Consultancy Services, India's IT behemoth, are widely viewed as a harbinger of tougher times ahead for the sector. It is clouding the outlook on wages as well. Some 34.7 per cent of respondents anticipate their



HARDIK CHHABRA

DEMAND DROUGHT The Chanakya mall in New Delhi

Q. Have flagship initiatives like 'Make in India' and 'Digital India' made a difference to your life?



More than half say 'Make in India' and 'Digital India' have impacted their lives